

out a specific dessert time during the day after which children will be invited to brush their teeth. Ideally, children should brush their teeth after every meal and before bedtime. Plaque is formed continuously, and only eliminating it again and again can prevent its harmful effects.

COMMON HEALTH PROBLEMS AMONG CHILDREN

When children manifest signs of illness, the caregiver should communicate those signs immediately to the employer and follow their instructions to the letter. It is important to note that infections in children may progress faster than in adults, and that sudden disinterest, inertia and high fever in children are symptoms that must be taken seriously. Some common children's diseases are listed below, but it is important to remember that this list is not exhaustive and that the symptoms described below can be difficult to distinguish from each other. Caregivers should therefore always inform parents if the children experience symptoms of diseases and make sure they know who to contact in case of an emergency.

Hardness of breathing is always potentially life threatening and emergency services must be contacted.

On accepting employment, a caregiver must ask employers the following questions:

- What are the agreed measures to take in case of emergency?
- Does the child have any known health issues that the caregiver should be made aware of?
- Is the child/are the children undergoing a treatment? What is the schedule, dosage and mode of application of the treatment?
- What should be done if the child presents symptoms of illness?
- What are the telephone numbers of the responsible persons and nearby relatives?
- What is the address and telephone number of the doctor and the nearest medical Centre?

KNOWING YOUR WAY AROUND COMMON ILLNESSES

COMMON ILLNESS	CAUSES & SYMPTOMS	PREVENTION	TREATMENT
Diarrhea	Consists in at least three loose or liquid bowel movements each day. It lasts for a few days and can result in dehydration due to fluid loss. High temperatures also increase the risk of dehydration. Diarrhea can be life threatening when the child is less than 1-year-old; cries without tears, has a dry mouth or cannot pee; his/ her eyes are sunken; is irritable, sluggish, does not want to drink or has a fever; his/her discharge contains blood.	✓ Proper hygiene around the preparation of food. ✓ Wash your hands before feeding the baby. ✓ Boil the water prior to preparing milk bottles. ✓ Flush water through the teat after feeding and before washing/boiling the bottle. ✓ Wash cooking and drinking utensils properly after every use.	Consult the parents, who in turn will consult the doctor or pediatrician. In the meantime, caregivers should keep children hydrated by giving them liquids to drink. They should never give medication without express indication of the parents, guardians or doctor.
Respiratory infections	Respiratory infections such as colds, flu, or bronchitis affect children, especially those under 5 years of age. During the winter the chances of contracting diseases increase. Respiratory diseases spread by direct contact with the virus such as when an infected person coughs or sneezes, spreading microscopic drops of saliva	✓ Wash hands frequently with soap and water. ✓ Cover mouth with disposable tissues when coughing or sneezing, or cough and sneeze in the corner of the elbow. ✓ Dispose of tissues immediately after use.	You must be alert to the following symptoms: fever, rapid breathing (agitation), coughing, moaning, whistling in the chest, loss of appetite, excessive sleeping. It is important to note that if a child demonstrates difficulties in breathing, this can be life-threatening, and parents should be notified immediately.

	containing the virus. Respiratory diseases produce inflammation of the nose, throat, ears, bronchi and lungs.	✓ Wash hands after coughing and sneezing.	
Fever cramps	Fever cramps are most common with virus infections and for children between 6 months and six years old. The child becomes completely stiff or the child's arms and legs can twitch. The child's gaze can become glazed, and it can stop breathing. Fever cramps are usually over after a few minutes, and it is common for children to be very tired afterwards. Experiencing this for a caregiver can be scary, but fever cramps are usually not dangerous.	If instructed by the parent, give fever reducing medication according to instructions.	Monitor breathing. Make sure the child is not too hot, take of covers and warm clothes, or cool the child with a wash cloth dipped in tepid water. A child that has never had cramps before, should be examined by a doctor. Parents should be informed about cramps and convulsions, to make sure other and more serious illnesses (like epilepsy) can be ruled out.
Heat stroke	Condition caused by the body overheating, usually because of prolonged exposure to or physical exertion in high temperatures. Body temperature may rise to 40°C or higher.	✓ Avoid direct sunlight between ten in the morning and four in the afternoon. ✓ Keep children under one years old in the shade.	Periodically give children room temperature water to drink. Mix a teaspoon of salt in a liter of water to compensate lost minerals. Move to a cool, ventilated place.

MODULE TWO SUMMARY

- 1. Definition of Terms.**
- 2. Child Care.**
- 3. Different Types of Childcare.**
- 4. Factors to Consider When Choosing Childcare.**
- 5. Child Development.**
- 6. The Domains of Child Development.**
- 7. Promoting Health Nutrition & Eating Habits Among Children According to Age.**
- 8. Nutrition for Children Who Are Sick.**
- 9. Identifying & Dealing with Allergies.**
- 10. Bathing a Child.**
- 11. Brushing Teeth.**
- 12. Changing Diapers.**
- 13. Common Health Problems Among Children.**

